Brandasund Peterson

Growing up, I was surrounded by a family of creative people. Musicians, artists, and writers all encouraged me to pursue any creative hobbies I had when I was young. At age 15, I began planning a career in the arts, in which I started taking online courses for illustration. As I went through my associates degree and began planning my bachelors, I realized that alongside my own artistic endeavors I wanted to teach the skills I have learned to the younger generations. Beyond the technical skills of “art”, I also want to teach people about creativity, ingenuity, and process. I believe that these concepts are an important part of being human, and that having some form of creative outlet is healthy for people. Additionally, I think art inherently promotes problem solving, which is an important ability to learn for any age.

In my classroom, I hope to achieve a dynamic space in which students can both learn and experiment. Regardless of grade level, whether it be younger or older students, I strive to reach a balance between study and studio time. I believe that teaching the fundamental elements of art and design through various lessons and projects will be beneficial to all students creatively. This is because many of these elements are translatable to other mediums, beyond just drawing and painting. Elements such as line, shape, or color can be translated into things like sculpture, fashion, and photography. By teaching students the fundamentals of art and design in school, it will give them a firm foundation to move forward and experiment with alternative creative pathways beyond the classroom.

Depending on the grades in which I would be teaching, there are a variety of methods for teaching these fundamentals. If I am working with younger students, I may choose to teach more indirectly. Shorter lectures and more engaging demonstrations, as well as moving at a slower pace for projects may benefit the younger audience. Additionally, a larger presence of the teacher will be necessary, as students in this age group will need more guidance to achieve their artistic goals. If I am working with an older audience, I may need less nuance, and a more straightforward approach. Students in the older age group will likely have enough structure and knowledge of art that I may begin to expand into more complex concepts. While I certainly do not plan to talk the whole class, I will be allocating time throughout the week for informative discussions and demonstrations about fundamentals that relate to the current unit/ project.

I believe in an inclusive and equal classroom environment for all students. I also believe in putting the individual student first, and accommodating any needs that student may have. In order to achieve these goals of accommodation and inclusivity, I will be a present and active teacher, going around the classroom and answering any questions as needed. If the student has an IEP or a 504 plan, I will thoroughly review it and make sure the student understands they can come to me after class or during office hours with any issues or assistance they may need. Additionally, I plan to make guideline packets for each lesson for students who may have trouble understanding or paying attention during class, so that they may complete the project at their own pace. The student may also record the class as long as they ask me first. Any other accommodations outside of what is outlined in the students IEP or 504 plan may be discussed with me at any point throughout the year. Additionally, if there is a project that I see a student is struggling with, I will offer them the opportunity to work on a similar but more accessible project that is worth an equal grade. I will also use these moments as an opportunity to modify the lesson plan and make necessary changes for future projects.

Students should expect to do work when they come into the classroom, and treat that work with the same effort and care they would any other assignment. When grading, I will

mainly focus on the participation of the individual students, basing the grades off of the effort put in rather than the quality of the final product. Additionally, I will better understand the student and be able to gauge their progress with the help of different formative assessment activities. Entrance/ exit tickets, lightning questions, and short quizzes will give me insight into the students mindset regarding an activity, as well as if they have been paying attention to the concepts I have been teaching.

While I plan on being a lifelong teacher, I also plan on being a lifelong learner. As stated previously, alongside teaching, I will continuously be pursuing my own artistic endeavors. This means I will continuously be learning more about art, and in turn, bring those new concepts into the classroom. I believe that art is forever changing, and that teachers should constantly be changing their lessons to be relevant to the current generation.